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CONTENTSYSTEM.AI

MODULE 4.3

Prompting and *Iteration*

AI does not suck. Your prompts do. The skill that separates people who make this work from people who quit in two weeks.

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Prompting and Iteration

There is a saying that goes around about AI, and it is worth getting straight. **AI does not suck. Your prompts do.**

These AI tools are built by companies worth billions, in some cases trillions, of dollars. When the output is bad, the tool is almost never the problem. The problem is that the instructions you gave it were vague.

VAGUE

"Just give me a haircut."

You sit down at the barber, say "just give me a haircut," and you have **no idea** what you are going to walk out with.

SPECIFIC

"Length on the sides, this fade, cleanup on the back."

You tell the barber exactly what you want and you walk out happy. **The AI is the same.** Specific instructions give you what you actually wanted.

So when people say AI is not good enough, what is usually true is that their prompts are not good enough. Getting good at this business means getting good at prompting.

Two kinds of prompts

Image prompts

The most important kind, for the reason covered in the last module. The image carries the video, so this is where you put the most care.

Video prompts

Describes the action you want in the clip. Important, but downstream of the image.

The workflow you already know

Use an AI assistant like Claude to write your prompts for you. You describe the action you want, you upload your reference image and your product image so it understands what it is working

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with, and you tell it to write a prompt for the specific video model you are using. It writes the prompt, you run it, and you adjust from there. **You are using one AI to write the instructions for another AI.** That is normal, and it is how you get clean, detailed prompts without writing every one from scratch.

The part people quit on too early

You are not going to get the perfect video on the first try. You are going to get errors. The product will look bugged, the person will not do quite what you wanted, something will be off. **That is expected.** When you get an error, the move is simple. Take a screenshot of the problem, give it back to the AI that wrote your prompt, tell it what went wrong, and have it fix the prompt so the error does not happen again. Then you run it again. You repeat that until it is right.

THE REAL DIVIDE

The people who win are the ones willing to **run it again and again** until the video is genuinely good. The people who lose accept a mediocre result, post it anyway, get low views, and quit in two weeks. It does not matter if a single video takes you hours when you are starting out. What matters is that you build the skill of getting it right. Once you have that skill, the speed comes on its own.

Build a library of winning prompts

One habit that compounds: when a prompt and a generation produce a video that actually works, save it. Keep a document or folder with every prompt that landed, what it produced, and which model and settings you used. Over time this library becomes one of your most valuable assets. Instead of writing every prompt from scratch and iterating from zero, you reach back into your library and reuse a structure you already know works, changing only the small parts that need to change.

"A beginner treats every video as a one-off. An operator treats every winning prompt as a tool."

If your prompts are good in the first place, you barely have to iterate at all on the next one. This is what takes you from spending hours on a single video to producing many videos quickly.